Artist Statement II

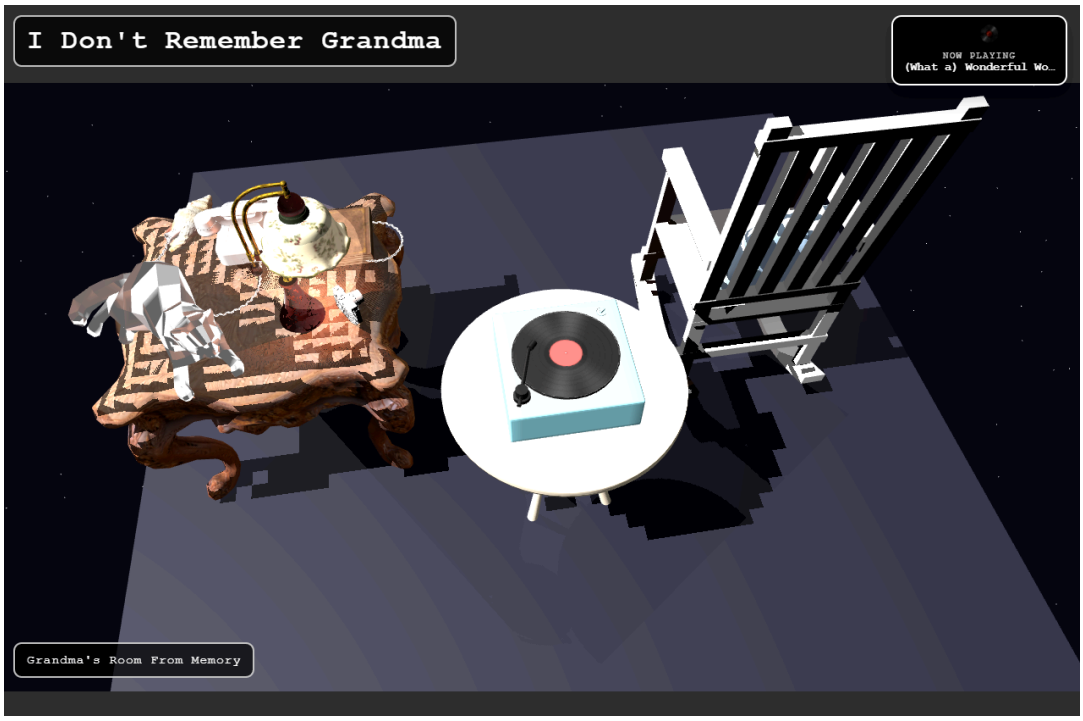
CART 263 Final Project -“I Don’t Remember Grandma” by Kaisa Catt

I really liked the planet collaboration project we did in Task 7 and especially the idea of a large empty universe so I used the code for the environment as my starting point so credit for that. I didn’t really know what direction to take but since I was using Three.js I decided to take advantage of that and began looking through free 3D models available online. This led me to think about what objects might be relevant/important to me and how my early interactions with certain items and people had a huge effect on what I’m continuing to pursue today and my artistic process. The first item that came to mind reminded me of a space long gone. That being a conch shell that my Grandma figure kept in her room. I vividly remember when I would visit her I was fascinated by the fact that supposedly if you put the shell to your ear you would hear the ocean. I now understand that it is just the sound of your circulation but it brought up a whole bunch of other memories for me.

This then led me to try to capture the space as I remember it; however, I realize there are many gaps in my memory since my ‘Grandma’ passed years ago and I didn’t get to visit her before she was gone due to COVID regulations at the time. I never really processed my grief and I wanted to recreate the space that now only exists in my mind. The placement of the open room in the middle of the universe among the stars with parts missing is a nod to how I can no longer picture the original room with gaps in my memory but by implementing the physical things I could remember brought me a sense of comfort that parts of her will never disappear. There are many sensations that bring me back like playing with her rotary phone and camera, leafing through her photo books, putting on a record and the gentle movement of the rocking chair. She isn’t in the scene herself as a representation of how I no longer remember her and that it’s natural, although painful, to let her go. I often deal with grief by imagining the person is just on a long trip even though I know it’s not true. I don’t want them to be gone and my brain has a hard time grasping their disappearance from my life.

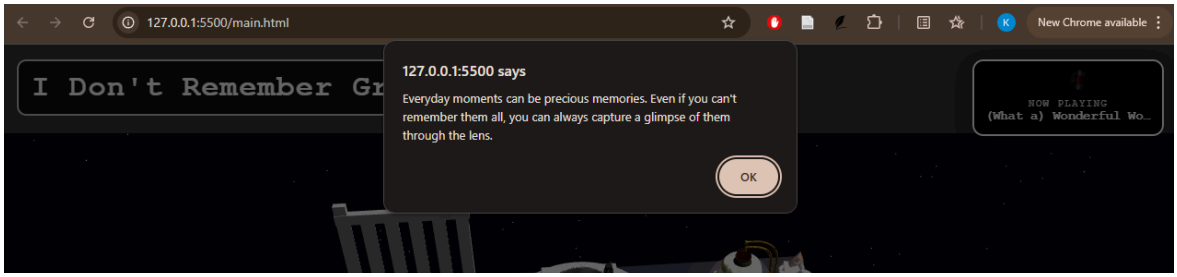
I wanted to capture how engaging with the items from the room gives me flashbacks to certain moments and senses while acknowledging that the person “supposed” to be there may not physically be there but they live on through what they left behind. I found that a 3d recreation of what I remembered strengthened my memories and exploring these items could explain why I am myself. For instance I recall playing with a camera which made me think about how my current interest and love for photography could stem partly from that experimentation as a child. Another is listening to records of music from the 1950-60s and watching the vinyl spin around as I have continued to maintain a turntable and a small vinyl record collection.

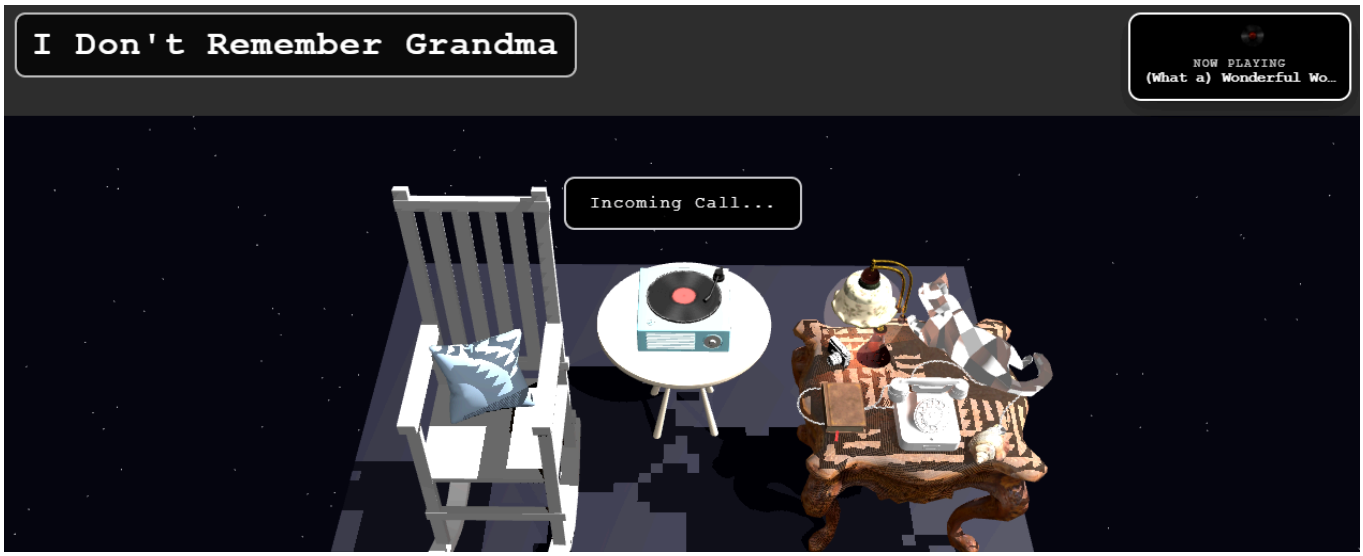
Main UI and view of the room while playing a record

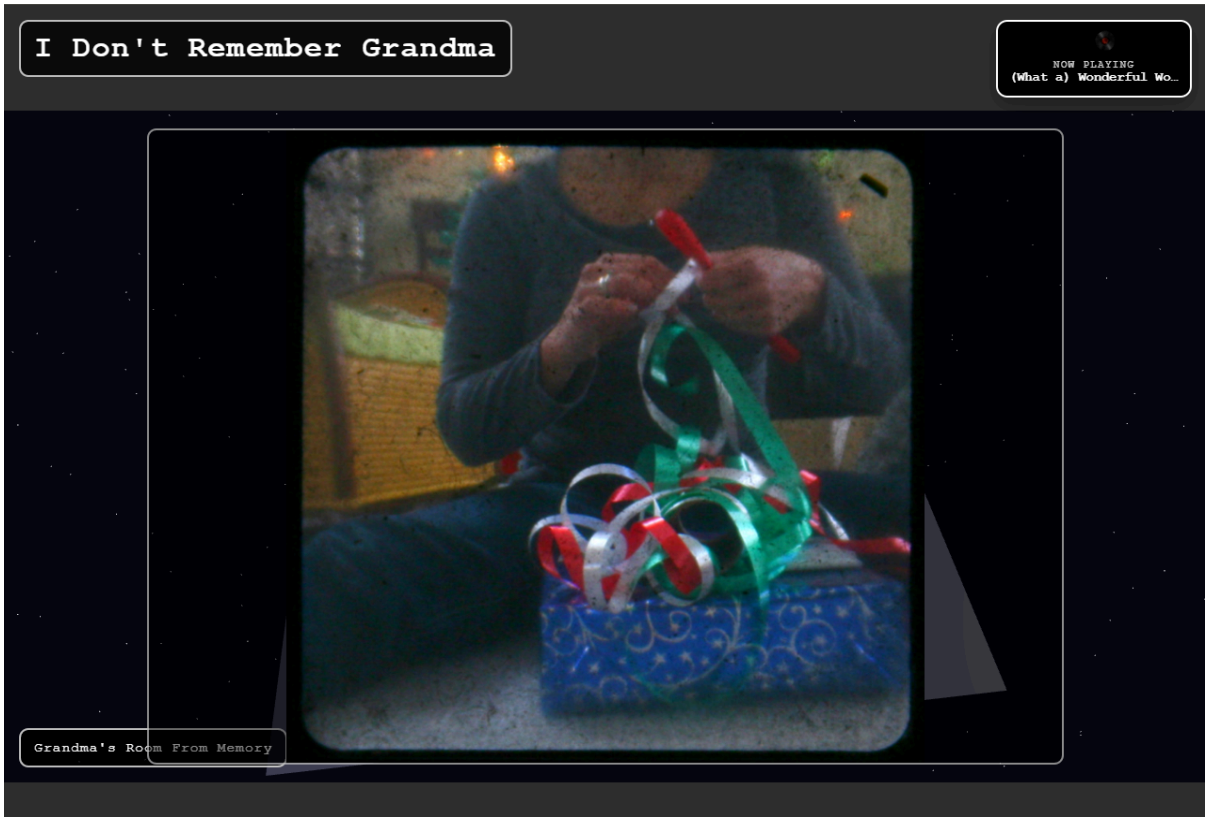


Further away view

Message alerts/events when interacting with certain items:







References

The Goodbye Line is a collection of free working payphones across the US that people can use to say goodbye to someone or something they never got the chance to say some last words to. The goal of the project is to give people the strength to let go of what's gone and to anonymously release their emotions in a healthy way in order to promote "public intimacy" in our ever increasingly solitary lives. People can call the number at any time to submit a voicemail of something they've been keeping within themselves whether it's grief or to thank a stranger or anything on their mind. The aim at the end of the day though is to remind people that although loss is difficult and people are told to hide it away we have all had this human experience that bonds us and we don't have to suffer in silence.

Before I Forget, originally published in 2020 by 3-Fold Games, is a short narrative exploration game that deals with memory, specifically through a character, Sunita, who has early onset Alzheimer's Disease. Through Sunita players explore her living space which has become unfamiliar and maze-like to her in order to try to piece together her life story. The player guides Sunita through her home and by interacting with all the objects around in the space they can begin to piece together her past and what made her herself. As the player explores through Sunita's eyes she begins to remember memories linked to items such as mementos and experiences enough to explain her past and understand her present.

Asset References:

conch-seashell: https://www.cgtrader.com/items/6164563/download-page
ocean audio:
shell img: https://pngimg.com/image/18238
waves on beach vid: https://pixabay.com/videos/sea-wave-golden-sand-sunrise-4006/

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call sounds:
https://pixabay.com/sound-effects/search/answering%20machine/
https://pixabay.com/sound-effects/search/rotary-phone/

old book: https://www.cgtrader.com/items/3703442/download-page
page flip sound: https://pixabay.com/sound-effects/search/flip/
Collages made by me from various personal photos and royalty-free assets
Pixelation done using: https://pixelartvillage.com/

record player:
https://www.cgtrader.com/free-3d-models/various/various-models/gramophone-vinyl
play music: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6b0YGLKLPvQ
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lamp:
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cool table:https://www.cgtrader.com/items/5346581/download-page

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